

◀ GLADIUS AND SCABBARD

Date c.15CE

Origin Rome

Length 57.5cm (22½in)

This *gladius* (legionary sword) and ornate scabbard was probably presented by the Emperor Tiberius to a favoured officer. Its decoration shows the Emperor dedicating a victory to his stepfather Augustus.



▲ PUGIO

Date 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Material Steel

The legionary's *pugio* (dagger) was a backup weapon if his sword could not be deployed. It was worn on the left for ordinary soldiers and frequently had an ornate scabbard inlaid with metal or enamel. The object shown here is a modern replica.

Classically styled "hair"



Soldiers were clean-shaven at this time

▲ MASK FOR CAVALRY SPORTS

Date 1st century BCE–1st century CE

Origin Nola, Italy

Material Bronze

At military displays, cavalrymen wore ornate helmets with face masks, often when they took part in mock battles. The mask was attached to the main part of the helmet with leather straps, and a crest and streamers added to the impressive appearance.

Legionary eagle standard in shrine



► SLING BULLETS

Date 3rd–1st centuries BCE

Origin Roman Empire

Weight 37.5–64.5g (1¼–2¼oz)

Length 3.2–4.4cm (1¼–1¾in)

Roman armies included lighter-armed troops, whose weaponry included slings with lead pellets such as these. The legions also had some heavier artillery that shot larger, pointed bolts.

Regimental brand



► PILUM AND HASTA

Date Late 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Length 2m (6½ft)

The Roman military *pilum* (javelin) was a throwing weapon, designed so that its pointed head would break off on hitting a target, making it impossible to hurl back. The *hasta* (thrusting spear) was a more substantial spear, used to thrust in close-quarter combat. The versions shown here are modern replicas.

HASTA

PILUM

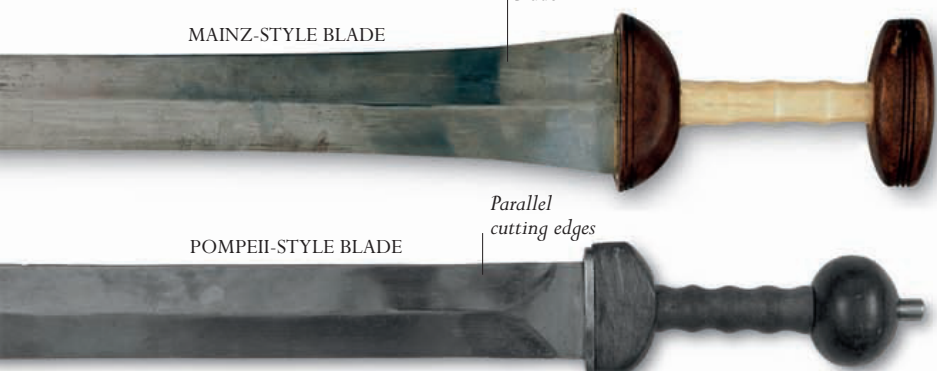


Waisted blade

MAINZ-STYLE BLADE

Parallel cutting edges

POMPEII-STYLE BLADE



◀ GLADII

Date 1st–3rd centuries CE

Origin Roman Empire

Weight 700–900g (25–32oz)

Length 65–70cm (26–28in)

Based on a short Spanish sword, the *gladius* had a narrow blade with a long point, making it effective for stabbing and thrusting. As can be seen in the modern replicas pictured here, the blade shape evolved from the waisted "Mainz" style to the straight-edged "Pompeii" type, which then evolved into the longer, straight-bladed *spatha* (slashing sword).